GGG-H-131c
MAY 31, 1957
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GGG-H-131b
January 19, 1955

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HATCHET (CLAW, HALF, LATHING, BROAD AND BARREL)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers hatchets used by craftsmen in carpentry and for opening barrels, boxes, and crates (see 6.1).

1.1.1 *Federal specification coverage.*—Federal specifications do not include all types and sizes of the commodity indicated by the titles, but cover only those most commonly used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types.* — Hatchets covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type B.—Claw.
Type C.—Half.
Type D.—Lathing.
Type F.—Broad.
Type G.—Barrel (produce or box opening).

1.2.2 *Sizes.*—Sizes shall be as shown for each type, and as specified herein.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

NN-H-93—Handles; Hickory, Striking-Tool.

PPP-P-31 — Preservation, Packaging, Packing and Marking of Material; and Shipping Instructions (Domestic Shipment and Storage).

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-P-15424 — Packaging of Hand Tools for Domestic and Overseas Shipment and Storage.

FSC Class 5110

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Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL–STD–129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Design and manufacture.—All hatchet heads shall be hammer-forged. The design shall be as shown on the applicable figure for the type hatchet required (see 1.2.1).

3.1.1 *Illustrations.* — The illustrations shown herein are for the convenience of identification and are not intended to preclude the purchase of hatchets which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification (see 6.3).

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 *Hatchet head.* — The hatchet head shall be of high-grade forging steel, free from all imperfections that may adversely affect the serviceability or durability of the finished product (see 3.12).

3.2.2 *Handles.*—Handles shall be of hickory wood conforming to grade AA or A of Federal Specification NN–H–93, at the option of the contractor, unless otherwise specified (see 6.2).

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 *Blades or bits.*—The blades or bits shall be properly hardened and tempered for a distance extending at least ¾ inch back from the cutting edge and shall show a Rockwell hardness reading between 50 and 60 on the C scale under a 150-kilogram major load. Care shall be exercised when grinding the bevels so as not to overheat and reduce the hardness of the cutting edge. Two hardness readings shall be taken approximately ⅜ inch back from the cutting edge or just above the ground bevel (see 4.4.1).

3.3.2 *Eye.*—The eye shall be properly heat-treated and of such size, shape, and strength as to prevent buckling, cracking, breaking, or spreading in ordinary use. The difference in the thickness of corresponding sections of opposite walls of the eye of any hatchet shall not exceed $\frac{1}{32}$ inch. The median line of the eye shall be in proper alignment with the cutting edge of the hatchet. All hatchets shall show at the eye a Rockwell hardness of not more than 26 on the C scale under a 150-kilogram major load (see 4.4.1). The size of the eye in all hatchets designed for wood handles, except type F, shall be larger at the wedge end than at the handle entrance in order to hold the head safely when secured with wedges. The eye in type F hatchets shall be larger at both ends than in the center section in order that handles may be inserted from either end, and the head safely secured with wedges (see 4.4).

3.3.3 *Top of head.*—The tops of the heads of all hatchets shall be properly hardened and tempered to show a Rockwell hardness reading between 50 and 60 on the C scale under a 150-kilogram major load. The claw portion on type B hatchets shall show a Rockwell hardness of not more than 40 on the C scale under a 150-kilogram major load (see 4.4.1).

3.3.4 *Straightness of blade or bit.* — The ground bevel(s) of all hatchets shall be straight within $\frac{1}{64}$ of an inch when checked against a standard straightedge placed parallel to the cutting edge. Also, the side of the blade or bit opposite the ground bevel on type F hatchets shall meet this straightness for a distance extending at least ¾ inch back from the cutting edge.

3.3.5 *Assembled hickory handles.*—Handles shall be properly fitted and secured to the head with metal wedges or metal screws

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in such a manner as to preclude probability of the head working loose or flying off the handle under ordinary service conditions. Wood wedges may be used, but wood wedges alone will not be acceptable. The shape and dimensions of handles assembled in types B, C, and D hatchets shall conform to the illustration of the 14-inch hatchet handle in Federal Specification NN–H–93, except that a fitting allowance in the over-all length will be permitted.

3.4 Surface finish.—The top of the head of each hatchet, except types D and G, shall have a ground and polished finish. The cutting edge or bevel of all hatchets shall be ground, sharpened, and polished, ready for service without need for further attention. The finish of all polished surfaces shall be not coarser than that resulting from the use of an 80-grit abrasive wheel, dry, when good commercial technique is employed. The blade or bit and body of all hatchets, except polished surfaces, shall have a smoothly ground finish not coarser than that resulting from the use of a 60-grit abrasive wheel, dry, when good commercial technique is employed.

3.5 Coating.—The blade or bit and body of all hatchets, except polished surfaces, shall be neatly coated with paint, lacquer, or enamel.

3.6 Identification marking.—Each hatchet shall be marked on the side of the head in a permanent and legible manner with the manufacturer's name or trade-mark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined. When specified (see 6.2), the capital letters "U.S." not less than ⅜ inch high shall also be permanently stamped on the side of each hatchet head.

3.7 Type B, claw hatchet.—The claw portion of the hatchet shall be properly hardened and tempered to show a Rockwell hardness reading of not more than 40 on the C scale under a 150-kilogram major load. The claw is defined as the section having the beveled slot, the claw length being the same length as the beveled slot plus ½ or minus ¼ inch. The entire top surface of the head and claw shall be finished as specified in 3.4. The claw shall be either an inclined taper claw or a curved claw, and shall have a beveled slot suitable for drawing both headless and headed nails. The extreme edge of the claw where the inclined taper or curve terminates, shall have a thickness of between 1/32 and 1/16 of an inch. Type B hatchets shall be furnished with the head and handle assembled, shall be similar to figure 1, and shall conform to the requirements shown in table I.

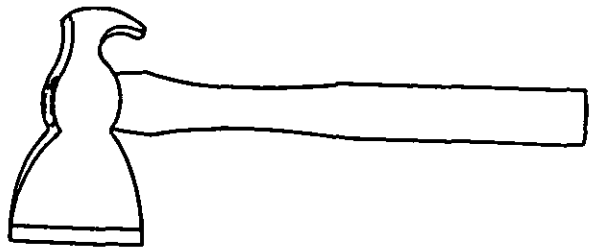


FIGURE 1.—Type B, claw hatchet.

TABLE I.—*Type B, claw hatchet*

Width at cutting edge, + ¼ — ¼	Length of head from cutting edge to top of head		Weight without handle	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
Inches	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Ounces*	*Ounces*
3⅛	5⅛	6¾	22	31

3.8 Type C, half hatchet.—Half hatchets shall be furnished with the head and handle assembled and shall comply with the requirements shown in table II for the size as indicated by the width of the cutting edge specified (see 6.2). The near side of the head shall have a beveled slot suitable for drawing nails. Type C hatchets shall be similar to figure 2.

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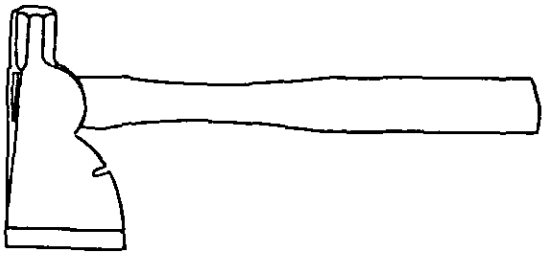


FIGURE 2.—Type C, half hatchet.

TABLE II.—*Type C, half hatchets*

Width at cutting edge, + ¼ — ¼	Length of head from cutting edge to top of head		Weight without handle	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
Inches	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Ounces*	*Ounces*
3¼ ----	5¾	6⅝	14	20
3½ ----	5⅞	6⅞	18	26

3.9 **Type D, lathing hatchet.** — Lathing hatchets shall be furnished with the head and handle assembled. The near side of the head shall have a beveled slot suitable for drawing nails. The tops of heads shall have machine-cut checkered serrations. Type D hatchets shall conform to the requirements shown in table III and shall be similar to figure 3.

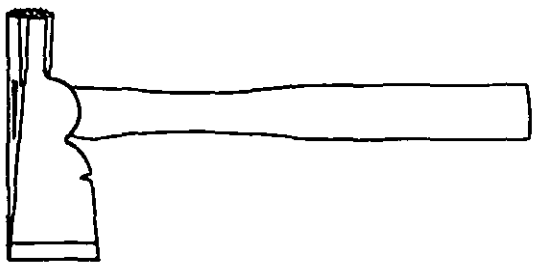


FIGURE 3.—Type D, lathing hatchet.

TABLE III.—*Type D, lathing hatchet*

Width at cutting edge, + ¼ — ¼	Length of head from cutting edge to top of head		Weight without handle	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
Inches	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Ounces*	*Ounces*
2¼ ----	6	6¾	12	17

3.10 **Type F, broad hatchet.** — Broad hatchets shall comply with the requirements shown in table IV for the size as indicated by the width at cutting edge specified (see 6.2). Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), broad hatchets shall be furnished with the head and handle assembled. The bit shall be beveled on one side only, and when assembled the bevel shall be on the right hand side when the hatchet is held by the right-hand for a downward cutting stroke. Type F hatchets shall be similar to figure 4.

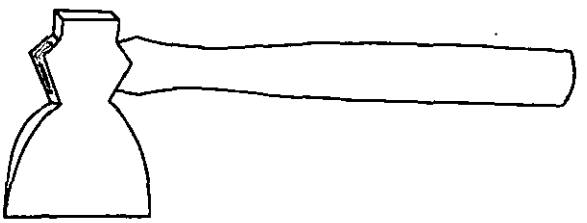


FIGURE 4.—Type F, broad hatchet.

3.11 **Type G, barrel (produce or box opening).** — Barrel hatchets shall be furnished with the head and handle assembled and shall have two beveled slots suitable for drawing nails. The near side of the head shall have one slot; the other slot shall be located on the

TABLE IV.—*Type F, broad hatchets*

Width at cutting edge, + ¼ — ¼	Length of head from cutting edge to top of head		Weight without handle		Length of handle overall when driven	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
Inches	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Pounds*	*Pounds*	*Inches*	*Inches*
4½ ----------	5¾	6½	1¾	2⅛	14½	16¼
5½ ----------	6¼	7⅛	2⅛	3¼	15½	17½

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cutting edge. The tops of heads shall have machine-cut checkered serrations. Type G hatchets shall conform to the requirements shown in table V and shall be similar to figure 5.

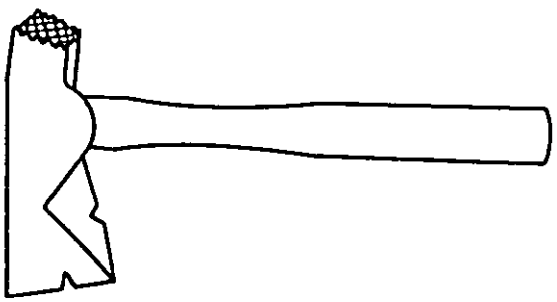


FIGURE 5.—Type G, barrel (produce or box opening) hatchet.

3.12 Workmanship. — Hatchets shall be smoothly finished throughout and the workmanship shall be first class in every respect. Hatchets shall be free from hardening checks or cracks, forging laps or pits, scale, rust, or imperfections of any nature which may adversely affect their durability or serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.1.1 *Inspection lot.*—All hatchets of the same type and size offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of acceptance examination and tests.

4.1.2 *Sampling for visual and dimensional examination.*—A random sample of hatchets shall be selected from each lot of material offered for Government inspection in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105 at inspection level III for lots of 40 and under, inspection level II for lots of 41 to 300 and inspection level I for lots over 300. The acceptable quality level shall be equal to 1.5 percent defective.

4.1.3 *Sampling for lot acceptance tests.*—A random sample of hatchets shall be selected from each inspection lot in accordance with the appendix to Military Standard MIL–STD–105 at inspection level L–8. The acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 percent defective. However, the sample size shall be the number associated with the letter in the table in the appendix and the acceptance number shall be zero until the acceptable quality level permits zero or greater.

4.2 Visual and dimensional examination.—Each of the sample hatchets selected in accordance with 4.1.2 shall be visually and dimensionally examined at the place of manufacture by the Government inspector to verify compliance with the requirements of this specification not involving tests (see 3.2). Any hatchet in the sample containing one or more visual or dimensional defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective hatchets in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected. Rejected lots may be offered again for Gov-

TABLE V.—*Dimensions and weight for type G (barrel produce or box opening) hatchet*

Width at cutting edge, + 1/4 — 1/4	Length of head from cutting edge to top of head		Weight without handle		Length of handle overall when driven	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
Inches	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Ounces*	*Ounces*	*Inches*	*Inches*
2 1/4	5 5/8	6	11	16	11 1/4	12

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ernment inspection provided the contractor has repaired or removed all nonconforming hatchets. The Government inspector shall examine samples from such resubmitted lots to verify compliance with this specification.

4.3 Lot acceptance test.

4.3.1 *Testing of sample hatchets for lot acceptance.*—Each of the sample hatchets selected in accordance with 4.1.3 shall be tested in accordance with 4.4 to verify compliance with this specification. Any sample hatchet which does not meet the requirements for any of these characteristics shall be rejected, and if the number of nonconforming hatchets in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4 Test procedures.

4.4.1 *Hardness test.*—The bit, eye, claw, and top of head shall be tested to determine compliance with the hardness requirements of 3.3.1, 3.3.2, 3.3.3 and 3.7.

4.4.2 *Practical cutting test.*—Chips shall be easily cut from hardwood by striking approximately 10 heavy blows with each sample hatchet. After being tested, the samples shall show no evidence of chipping, dulling, or turning over of the cutting edges, loosening of handle or wedges, or any other damage that indicates inferior material or workmanship.

4.4.3 *Practical nail-drawing test (type B).*—At least 18 nails, 3 each of small, medium, and large sizes, of both headless and headed nails, shall be drawn from hardwood with each sample of type B claw hatchet. For purposes of this test, the nails shall not extend above the wood surface more than $\frac{1}{32}$ inch. After drawing the nails, the samples shall show no evidence of damage of any nature.

4.5 Rejected lots.—Rejected lots may be offered again for Government inspection provided the contractor has removed all nonconforming hatchets. Samples shall again be selected from such rejected lots and examined to verify compliance with this specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging and packing.

(Nonmilitary agencies.—Federal Standard No. 102 should be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1.1 *Levels A, B, and C.*—Hatchets shall be protected for each level in accordance with Military Specification MIL–P–15424.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 *Military agencies.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking for shipment shall in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

5.2.2 *Nonmilitary agencies.*—Marking for shipment shall be in accordance with the standard marking of Federal Specification PPP–P–31.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 Types B, C, D, and F hatchets are primarily for use in maintenance and construction by building tradesmen.

6.1.2 Type G hatchets are primarily for use in opening egg, fruit, and vegetable crates, boxes, barrels, and similar items.

6.2 Ordering data.—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and should specify the following:

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(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Type required (see 1.2.1).

(*c*) If grade AA or A hickory handle is required (see 3.2.2).

(*d*) If the capital letters "U.S." are required to be stamped on the side of each hatchet head (see 3.6).

(*e*) The width at the cutting edge when ordering type C or F hatchets (see 3.8 and 3.10).

(*f*) If type F hatchets are required unassembled (see 3.10).

(*g*) Whether the material shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with level A or C and packed in accordance with level A, B, and C (see 5.1.1).

6.3 This specification conforms with National Bureau of Standards "Simplified Practice Recommendation R160–42" insofar as is practicable.

6.4 Superseding data.—Type E of Federal Specification GGG–H–131a has been deleted. Type A of this specification has been replaced by type I, class 1, design D and design E, style 2, of Interim Federal Specification GGG–A–00926 (Navy-Ships).

6.5 Transportation description.

6.5.1 Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Hatches

Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility, nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—O C E Q T

Navy—Sh A MC Y

Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 10 cents each.

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